03.The Basics

Thursday, March 19, 2026 8:34 PM

Open a file in vim vim 'file'
If 'file' does not exist → it will create it
Quit : :q
:q! quit and dismiss any mode changes

Vim operates with Modes

Normal mode

→ when you open a file
→ keys have functionality
→ : starts a command
→ i switches to Insert Mode before cursor

Insert mode

→ keys are now just text
→ esc to go back to Normal Mode

:w write changes
a switches to Insert Mode after cursor
o switches to Insert Mode by adding a new line below cursor

shift + i enter Insert Mode at the beginning of current line
shift + a enters Insert Mode at the end of current line
shift + o enters Insert Mode by adding a new line above current

: set number activates line numbers

number + command does the command 'number' of times

← h ↑k ↓j l →

: set relativenumber displays relative numbers to current
: set mouse = a to allow mouse usage
: set tabstop = n how many columns of whitespace a tab has
: set shiftwidth = n no. of spaces used for indentation
: colorscheme
: set autoindent

~/.vimrc file with the vim configurations